I get it, I thought. They're busy! Building a family!

*Or maybe…they don't want a third wheel?*

*Maybe if I get married, things will be different?*

They'd both mentioned, pointedly, repeatedly, how much they liked Cressida.

## 71.

MARCH 2014. A CONCERT at Wembley Arena. Walking onstage I suffered the typical panic attack. I made my way to the center, clenched my fists, spat out the speech. There were fourteen thousand young faces before me, gathered for We Day. Maybe I'd have been less nervous if I'd concentrated more on them, but I was having a proper *Me* Day, thinking about the last time I'd given a speech under this roof.

Tenth anniversary of Mummy's death.

I'd been nervous then too. But not like this.

I hurried off. Wiping the shine from my face, and staggering up to my seat to join Cress.

She saw me and blanched. *You OK?*

*Yeah, yeah.*

But she knew.

We watched the other speakers. That is, she watched, I tried to catch my breath.

The next morning our photo was in all the papers and splashed online. Someone tipped off the royal correspondents to where we were sitting, and at long last we were outed. After nearly two years of secretly dating, we were revealed to be a couple.

Odd, we said, that it should be such big news. We'd been photographed before, skiing in Verbier. But these photos landed differently, maybe because this was the first time she'd joined me at a royal engagement.